

Syn Bank Share of Wallet Intelligence Engine

Team: The Independent Variable | Daniel Mataranyinka and Herton Mabongue | Data School Hackathon 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

We built a Share of Wallet Intelligence Engine that estimates each Syn Bank client's total banking wallet independently of Syn Bank's own transaction data, avoiding a structural flaw that would have made a naïve estimate mathematically incapable of varying by client (see below). Applied to real FY2025 financial disclosures for the 20 clients supplied, portfolio share ranges from **0.1% to 67.8%**, a spread that survives a **±25%** stress test on every benchmark assumption. The top five identified opportunities alone represent over **R5.5 billion** in annual fee upside, led by Shoprite Holdings, Sanlam, Glencore, Anglo American, and Vodacom Group.

THE BUSINESS PROBLEM AND ITS COMPLEXITY

Syn Bank sees every transaction that flows through Syn Bank — but none of those that flow through its competitors. Share of wallet therefore cannot be read from the internal data; it must be estimated from outside.

Our first model missed this. It sized the wallet from internal flow, then took captured volume as a fraction of that wallet:

$$\text{share} = (\text{wallet} \times \text{capture_ratio}) / \text{wallet} = \text{capture_ratio}$$

The wallet term cancels. Share was identical to the assumed capture rate and could not depend on the data. It passed every obvious check — values between 0 and 1, a plausible ranking — **while giving 20 very different companies the same answer**: 4.4 points of spread across a portfolio whose wallets differ by 2,757x.

OUR APPROACH

External Benchmarking: Estimated addressable flow from each client's published FY2025 financial statements, using revenue as a proxy for transactional banking, foreign revenue for FX, and cost of sales plus inventory for trade finance. Each pillar is scaled by an explicit South Africa attribution share to reflect Syn Bank's domestic banking footprint.

Internal Activity Analysis: Measured Syn Bank's currently captured flow from transactional, cross-border payment, and trade finance records, then compared this against estimated addressable flow to derive Share of Wallet and commercial gaps.

Shifting every flow multiple by **±25%** moves portfolio share only between **3.6% and 5.9%**; the captured side cannot move, because it is measured. Our multiples imply banking fees of approximately **0.47%** of revenue, inside the **0.4–0.7%** range the brief cites.

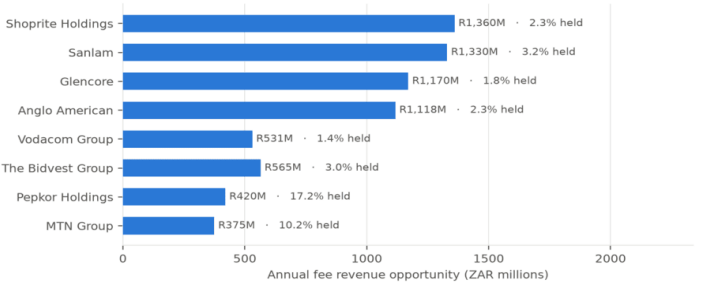
TOP PRIORITY OPPORTUNITIES - RECOMMENDED BANKER ACTIONS

Table 1: Five highest fee opportunities in the portfolio, ranked by annual upside

#	Client	Sector	Share	Fee Oppty / Yr	Lead With
1	Shoprite Holdings	Consumer Goods	2.3%	R1,360M	Transactional
2	Sanlam	Insurance	3.2%	R1,330M	Transactional
3	Glencore	Mining	1.8%	R1,170M	Transactional
4	Anglo American	Mining	2.3%	R1,118M	Transactional
5	Vodacom Group	Telecoms	1.4%	R531M	Transactional

The ranking prioritises winnable value over client size, weighting wallet gap at 50% alongside conversion ease, relationship depth, and 90-day urgency.

Transactional Banking leads for 19 of 20 clients, making cash-management consolidation the portfolio's most repeatable growth opportunity.



GENERATIVE AI, DOING REAL WORK

The model never supplies a number. Figures are computed by the engine, passed in as an evidence block, and reused verbatim; the model does language, not arithmetic. Every output is re-read by a grounding check that flags any Rand amount or percentage absent from the evidence. It writes pre-meeting briefings and answers open questions over the portfolio, and degrades to deterministic text if the API is unavailable.

LIMITATIONS

20 clients were supplied, not the 50 described. Flow multiples are benchmarks, not observations, and SA-attribution is the most judgemental input. Revenue basis differs by industry and is recorded per client; cost of sales and inventory are imputed from sector margins where not disclosed, and flagged. Gaps are attributed to competitors on the assumption that internal records are complete. Lending and DCM are out of scope.